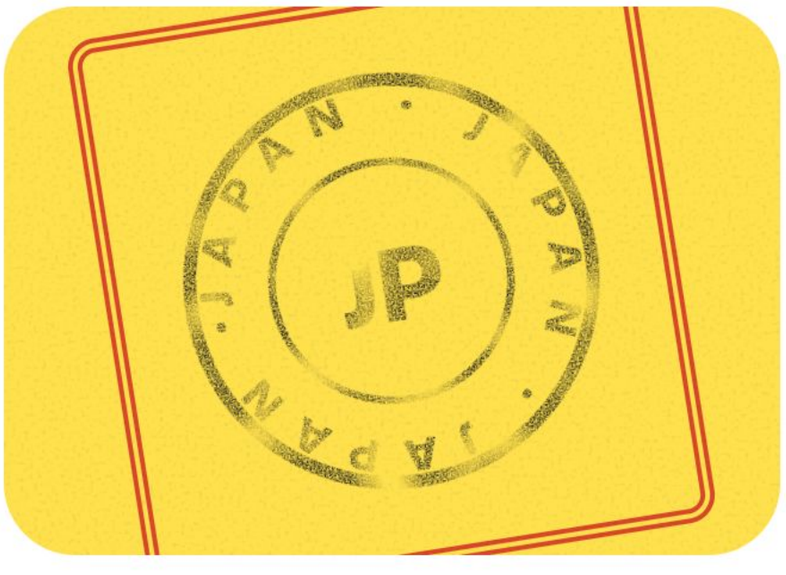
Localising English copy for Japan





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Decisions that change the read



Decision	What to watch
Length	Fewer characters, more space each
Katakana	Overuse sounds vague
Politeness	Pick a level and keep it
Line breaks	At natural word groups
Prices	円, tax included

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A process that works



Brief

A Japanese copywriter

Options

Two or three per headline

Review

Layouts with real Japanese text

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Break lines by meaning

Headline tools often split Japanese mid-phrase.

Set breaks by hand on key lines.

Breaks at word groups

Automatic breaks mid-word



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In Japan, localisation starts before the layout.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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